TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Recommend: Fix It, Replace It, or Wait?

Recommend | OREO | Make a Recommendation

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Find out what someone needs, drop one of three options (fix, replace, wait), recommend one with a condition, and answer one concern about it.

WHO You and Ali look after the office equipment. This morning Mei Ling's computer would not start. It is five years old, and this is its second problem this year.

SITUATION Ali has found three options: fix it, buy a new one, or wait until the new budget in January, three months away. The prices and times are in the boxes below.

NEED Mr. Tan wants a recommendation today. Mei Ling makes about 50 invoices a day on this computer, so it must work every day. There is RM1,500 left in this year's budget.

GOAL Drop one option, recommend one of the other two, say when it is the right choice, and answer Mr. Tan's concern.

Three options

- Fix it: new hard disk RM450 · ready in 2 days · 3-month warranty on the repair
- New computer: RM1,800 · ready in 3 days · 2-year warranty
- Wait until January (new budget, 3 months away) · until then, Mei Ling shares Siti's computer

What we need

- About 50 invoices a day
- A computer that works every day
- RM1,500 left this year

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mr. Tan asks: “Mei Ling’s computer is broken again. Should we fix it, buy a new one, or wait until January?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Ali’s answer. Mark where each part starts.

Waiting until January is too long: Siti needs her own computer all day. We need a computer that works every day, so I'd recommend a new one. The main reason is that this one keeps breaking. It’s five years old, and this is its second problem this year. Fixing it is cheaper, only RM450, but the repair only has a three-month warranty. A new one is RM1,800, RM300 over budget, but it has a two-year warranty. So overall, if we want a computer that works every day, a new one is the better choice.

O DROP ONE · RECOMMEND

R REASON

E COMPARE · EXAMPLE

O RECOMMENDATION AGAIN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Siti recommends what to do about the pantry fridge. Order: Recommend → Reason → Compare → Recommend again.

- [ ] A new fridge is about RM1,200, but the repair is only RM180 and takes one day.
- [ ] So overall, if it's the first problem, fixing it is the better choice.
- [ ] The main reason is that it's only two years old, and this is its first problem.
- [ ] Everyone keeps their lunch in it, so I'd recommend fixing the fridge this week.

Write the letter: **O** = Drop one · recommend · **R** = Reason · **E** = Compare · example · **O** = Recommendation again

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SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

ASK ABOUT THE NEED

- [ ] How old is it?
- [ ] How often do you use it?
- [ ] What's the budget?
- [ ] How many people use it?

DROP ONE OPTION

- [ ] Waiting is too long, because …
- [ ] … is over the budget, so it's out.
- [ ] It isn't worth fixing, because …

COMPARE

- [ ] Fixing it is cheaper, but …
- [ ] A new one costs more, but …
- [ ] … is faster / safer than …

RECOMMEND WITH A CONDITION

- [ ] We need …, so I'd recommend …
- [ ] If it keeps breaking, it's better to …
- [ ] If it's the first problem, …
- [ ] It may be better to wait until …

RESPOND TO A CONCERN

- [ ] I understand, but …
- [ ] That's a fair point. For now, we could …
- [ ] I see. In that case, I'd … instead.

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. Siti needs her own computer all day. [so / but / because] Waiting until January is too long.

2. Fixing it costs only RM450. [because / but / so] It's the second problem this year.

3. I'd recommend a new computer. [so / because / but] It has a two-year warranty.

4. It breaks again next month. [If … / For example, / because] We'll pay for another repair.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. A new computer _____ RM1,800. (A fact about an option now)
   - ○ costs
   - ○ costing
   - ○ to cost

2. Fixing it is _____ than buying a new one. (Comparing two options)
   - ○ cheapest
   - ○ more cheap
   - ○ cheaper

3. If we order a new one today, it _____ in three days. (What will happen)
   - ○ will arrive
   - ○ will arrives
   - ○ arriving

4. If it _____ again, we will pay for another repair. (The if part)
   - ○ to break
   - ○ breaking
   - ○ breaks

SLIDE 09 Comparing · too long · if … will

To recommend fix, replace or wait: drop one with too, compare the other two with -er / more … than, and say when your choice is right with if.

Waiting until January is **too long** for us.

Fixing it is **cheaper than** buying a new one, but a new one is **safer**.

If it **breaks** again, we **will** pay for another repair.

If it's the first problem, fixing it **is** the better choice.

SLIDE 10 Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

O DROP ONE · RECOMMEND

… is out, because … We need …, so I'd recommend …

R REASON

The main reason is …

E COMPARE · EXAMPLE

… is cheaper than …, but …

O RECOMMENDATION AGAIN

So overall, if …, … is the better choice.

SLIDE 11 Make a Recommendation

The recommender asks what the listener needs, drops one of three options (fix, replace, wait), recommends one with a condition and answers one concern. The listener writes a note.

1. Round 1 (3:00): say your card number and the three options. Ask about the need. Drop one, then recommend one.
2. Listener: fill the note; ask 'What if the budget isn't enough?' / 'What if it breaks again?' Recommender: 1–2 sentences.
3. Round 2 (2:00), shorter: line B moves one seat. Same card, new listener: need, drop one, recommend with if, one concern.
4. Round 3 (1:00), frames closed, no asking: 'You need …, so …'. Card only. Then swap roles and repeat rounds 1–3.

Card 1 · The meeting-room projector

Card 2 · The office air-con

Card 3 · A family washing machine

Card 4 · A car with no air-con

Listener's note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Card · asked first?			
Dropped · why			
Choice · condition (if)			
Concern: answered?			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. What if the budget isn't enough?
2. Can't we just wait until January?
3. What if it breaks again?

Start with: **I understand, but … · That's a fair point. For now, we could … · I see. In that case, I'd … instead.**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

A friend's phone screen is cracked in one corner, but the phone still works. It is three years old, and she has about RM1,200. Fix the screen: RM350, one hour at a shop in the mall. A new phone: RM1,500 now. Wait: the same phone is RM1,100 in the 12.12 sale in six weeks. Drop one and recommend one.

… is over her budget, so … · She needs …, so I'd recommend … · … is cheaper than …, but … · So overall, if …, …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Names the need, drops one option and recommends one of the other two.
- [ ] Compares the two options and says when the choice is right (if …).
- [ ] Acknowledges one concern and answers it, or changes the plan.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Need, drop one, recommend	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Comparing with a condition	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Answering a concern	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · The meeting-room projector

You are Kumar. When asked, tell them: the projector is six years old, you show slides to about 10 customers twice a week, and the budget is about RM2,500. Fill the note, then raise one concern.

Card 2 · The office air-con

You are Mr. Tan. When asked, tell them: the air-con is three years old, eight staff work under it all day, and the budget is about RM1,000. Fill the note, then raise one concern.

Card 3 · A family washing machine

You are Mei Ling. When asked, tell them: the machine is twelve years old and broke twice last year, the five of you wash every day, and you have about RM1,500. Fill the note, then raise one concern.

Card 4 · A car with no air-con

You are Ali. When asked, tell them: your car is eleven years old, you drive 40 minutes to work every day, and you have RM2,000 now and a bonus in December. Fill the note, then raise one concern.

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · The meeting-room projector

Fix: new lamp RM350, but the lamp takes one week to arrive. New projector: RM2,200, ready in 2 days, brighter, 2-year warranty. Wait: use the TV in Mr. Tan's room until January; only 4 people can see it well.

Card 2 · The office air-con

Fix now: gas top-up and cleaning RM250, done tomorrow. New unit: RM2,400 with fitting, ready in one week, uses less electricity. Wait: the service contract gives a free repair, but the technician can only come in 3 weeks.

Card 3 · A family washing machine

Fix: new motor RM350, ready in one week. Buy now: new machine RM1,300, delivered in 2 days, 2-year warranty. Wait: the same machine is RM950 in the year-end sale in 3 weeks. Self-service laundry nearby: RM10 a load.

Card 4 · A car with no air-con

Fix: new air-con compressor RM1,800, 3 days at the workshop. Replace: sell this car and buy a newer used one, about RM30,000 more. Wait: fix it later, when you have more money; until then, drive with the windows down.